

CARMINE

Name

Date

also called... Carmine 5297, Carmine (Coccus cacti L.), Carmine Ultra-Fine, Carminic Acid, Carminic Acid Lake , CI 75470, or Natural Red 4

What is it?

Carmine is the aluminum lake of cochineal, which a bright-red coloring agent that comes from the extract of dried bodies of the cochineal insect. It is often found in brightly colored ruby-red foods, meats/fish, ink, and cosmetics. It is also used to dye medications, ink, and other products.

Where might it be found?

Eye shadows, lipsticks, cosmetic blush, hair dyes and color, toothpaste, shampoos, sunscreen, yarn, ointments, fake flowers, herbal remedies, homeopathic therapies, handmade fabrics or “natural” clothing, red paint.

How to avoid it?

Avoid using any product containing carmine. Check the label of everything you use to find the complete ingredient list. If carmine is present, one of its names should appear in the ingredients. If no ingredient list is present, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or websites such as:

<http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>

<http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>

<http://www.drugstore.com>

Ask your partner, physical therapist, esthetician, masseuse, beautician, hairdresser, barber, and caretaker to avoid using products containing carmine in your contact or care.

These measures should help you avoid this allergen. By reading ingredient labels, you should be able to find safe alternatives that are free of it.

Carmine is in the coating of some oral prescriptions: For example, in some azithromycin tablets

Ask your doctor to check the ingredients of any medications prescribed to you to be sure no carmine is present, including in the coating of the medication.

Look for it in the ingredients of over-the-counter medicines like chewable vitamins, too

Some people who are sensitive to carmine notice a flare when they eat certain foods that contain the chemical. Your doctor may suggest you try a one month diet free of all such foods to see if you improve. You must check all food ingredient labels for carmine.

These may contain CARMINE:

Any range of pink-crimson to orange foods including yogurts, shrimp, imitation crab, red-colored drinks, juice (e.g. grapefruit and orange), sausages, chorizo, salami, popsicles, ice cream, wine, liquors, beer, red spices, syrups, canned fruits, chewing gum, frozen meat, fish, jam, caviar, ice cream, ketchup, vinegar, cheese, butter, delicatessen meats, cookies, gum drops.